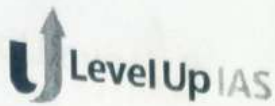


Q.7c (15 marks): Durkheim concept of sacred and profane provides alternative to secularization thesis



8.c)

How does Durkheim's idea of sacred and profane provides an alternative to secularization thesis.
(15 marks)

(Don't Write anything in this Area)

The sacred and profane dichotomy was first given by Emile Durkheim in his work "Elementary forms of Religious life (1912)".

Sacred refers to the objects, symbols & ideas that are awe inspiring, unexplainable and spiritually significant. Profane refers to the practical objects & ideas of every day life.

Secularization while sacred & profane relate to the idea of religion. The secularisation thesis postulates how there is a decline in religion owing to socio, political and economic developments.

Evidences :

- ① Attendance to Church : studies in France, Britain & Netherlands : only 5 % population now goes to church.

- 2) Post modernist : Belong without Belief → going to church only to renew social networks.
- 3) Generalisation of what were religious values before Ex: Vasundaiva Kumbhakam, Yoga not just related to Hinduism.

Despite the above studies there is still evidence that religion continues to exert the feeling of collectiveness as explained by Durkheim in his study of sacred & profane among the Arunta Tribe of Australia.

Several scholars talk of how religion is not diminishing but rather taking newer forms.

- 1) People may not be going to church but organise private gatherings
 - 2) Promotions of digital Darshe
 - 3) May strikes still have sacred groves which cause environmental protection as well
- cy) This though opposed by some, sacred & profane can be used to separate supernatural affair from worldly affairs in human societies.